

Ninety notes, sorted

1,137 insertions, 687 deletions, 90 margin comments — covering the Prologue through Chapter 11. Every note is matched against the current manuscript, so anything he flagged that’s already fixed is marked.

■ Fix now 20 ■ Needs your memory 22 ■ Your call 22 ■ He liked it 25 ■ Already handled 1

Fix now

Small, uncontested, and mine to do once you say go. **20**

☐ FIX NOW Ch 2 She picked us. What does this mean? She’s your biological mom. She had you, but picked you? Explain what you mean by this. If you mean she picked you over your dad, YES! That works. Clarify “She picked us.” He says if it means she picked you over your dad, that lands.
☐ FIX NOW — Omitted. Why would anyone ask you that? The question has no context. He cut a question that had no context. Agree.
☐ FIX NOW — Horacio Earlier you called him Papa. Be consistent. If you later chose to call him by his first name, explain your thinking. Papa vs. Horacio. Pick one per era and explain the switch when it happens.
☐ FIX NOW — Grandpa After humanizing him a way that goes further than strict, I think you should use the name you called him. “My grandfather” sounds too formal now. Use the name you called him, not “my grandfather.”
☐ FIX NOW — . Doesn’t need to be said. It’s a weak line followed by a great one. Don’t bury great lines. Cut the weak line before the good one. “Don’t bury great lines.”

☐ FIX NOW

Ch 4

Jon twenty-five at the time, all of us grown men by then

Why give age of just one? I suggest removing and leaving it at all grown men.

Give all their ages or none.

☐ FIX NOW

Ch 4

Not everything from those years was heavy.

Nothing of what you've been sharing in this chapter seems heavy. Delete.

Delete "heavy" — nothing in the chapter has been heavy yet.

☐ FIX NOW

—

Don't sell it. You've already SHOWN the concept in the next line.

You already showed it in the next line. Cut the selling.

☐ FIX NOW

—

Your turn at what? This sounds AI...like it should make sense, but it doesn't.

"When my turn came" — he flags it as AI. He's right, nothing establishes whose turn or at what.

☐ FIX NOW

Ch 5

LT CHOOSES COKE OVER PEPSI. Lawrence Taylor's troubles were public sport by then. Lou went down and took the sign, and it almost started a fight. I was a kid; I thought it was about football. It took me years to wonder whether it ...

Unless someone is from the area, of your age or older, and into football, this reference doesn't land. To make it fit, share a bit about LT's drug use and controversy. Then your ending sentences makes perfect sense.

Add a line about LT's drug trouble or the sign story doesn't land.

☐ FIX NOW

Ch 5

I had my own version of it

This sounds like you had your own version of "Hey Dad, we made it." But you didn't have a version of that saying but rather a version of the celebrating a shared feeling.

You didn't have a version of the saying — you had a version of the feeling.

☐ FIX NOW

Ch 5

"I love you as much as I love my own kids."

So, this is a repeat of something I commented on earlier. Cut the earlier one, since it's not hanging on anything concrete. This is more concrete, since it's adjacent to dad showing up, loving your unconditionally, and saying what you needed to hear.

Cut the earlier instance; this one is anchored to something concrete.

☐ FIX NOW

Ch 6

shot a double-leg

Explain. Assume your readers aren't wrestlers.

Explain the wrestling term for non-wrestlers.

☐ FIX NOW

—

fifth seed

explain

Explain.

☐ FIX NOW

—

Ramsey

Remind the reader what this is. The name of the school? If so, put the whole school name here.

Give the full school name.

☐ FIX NOW

—

single-leg

Explain simply

Explain simply.

☐ FIX NOW

Ch 7

came for me a decade late

That had Horatio

Fact fix: "That had Horacio."

☐ FIX NOW

—

I don't think you need a sub here. You were just talking about him.

Drop the subhead — you were already talking about him.

☐ FIX NOW

— already cut

I fell into a depression I didn't feel coming. My world went gray, lacking the contrast of either white or black When I talked to Lou on the phone, he could hear it in my voice. He didn't ask follow-up questions. Instead, he made ...

This kind of fragmented writing is the hallmark of AI. I provides some information but lacks personality.

He names this fragmented style as the hallmark of AI.

☐ FIX NOW

—

There's no context or set up for this comment. Why were you about to scatter? I get it that roaches like filth, and roaches scatter when you turn on the light. But was it the end of the year? This is another example of AI coming up with a line that seems fine on the surface but makes no sense when read critically.

"We were about to scatter" — he read it as roaches. The line is meaningless as written.

Needs your memory

Nobody but you can answer these. An editor can only mark them. **22**

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 2

My grandfather was strict. He'd never approved of the marriage, but he let us stay with him.

The three of us crowded in there for 3 or 4 months. Where? Something is off, and maybe I introduced an error in the chronology by moving the start of the chapter. Check out the 1st paragraph, and compare it to you grandfather letting you stay with them. You, your bro, and mom were three. Your grandparents make 5. Did Nancey live there too?

Who was in the grandparents' house, and for how long.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

—

How was he strict? Show us. Why didn't he approve?

Show one instance of your grandfather being strict.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 2

I didn't know how to love a man who was gone but not dead.

Get into your head as a child. Did your mom lie to you, saying Papa would join you all in NJ? What did she say to you?

What your mother actually told you about Papa joining you.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 2

Getting an education wasn't something he expected from them.

I don't know what to make of his thoughts. Is this a 1950s throwback, like woman should be pretty and quiet? I don't know that you have to name it in your book, but I'm curious. Depending on what you think his reasoning was, it might be an interested addition to add without commentary, like "According to grandpa, pretty women didn't need to be smart." Or something.

What you think your grandfather's reasoning was.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

— already cut

attended our (what) games and the matches,

Last we knew, you were 4. what games and matches were you involved in?

You were four. What games and matches?

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 2

years before she met Charlie

Is this her future husband. First mention. Who is he and what's his relationship with her?

Who is this and what is his relationship to her?

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 2

the boy in the backseat too scared to get out of the car.

You didn't share this story. But you should. Go back to her picking you up at the airport and stopping at your gparent's house. Make it a dialogue. My mom carried Chris into the house to keep him out of the cold. Nancey stayed with me. "Aren't you coming, Claudio?" I said nothing and buried my face. "You're going to like it here. I promise," she said gently. I didn't know this person. This place smelled funny. No one asked me if I wanted to do any of this. "You aren't scared, are you?" she asked patiently. "No!" I said, my lower lip sticking out. I lied. I was scared. Very.

He drafted sample dialogue for the airport scene. Needs your real memory, not his invention.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

—

Pines Lake

What state? State it

Name the state.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 3

My mother and Lou divorced in 1996, the year I turned eighteen. The divorce handed him an easy way out and every social permission to take it.

Don't just drop this on the reader. It reads as happy happy happy DIVORCE. Give us a paragraph that starts with, "As happy as I was having Lou as my dad, being a great father didn't extent to my mom and dad having a strong marriage. They (what? Fought? Someone cheated?). By 1996..."

The divorce arrives with no setup. Needs a paragraph, and only you know what happened.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 4

On the ferry from New Jersey to New York, the family car rolling on to cross the water, and me asking if we could put the car on the boat.

I don't understand. Isn't that what a ferry does. I think I'm missing something.

The ferry line — he can't follow it.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 4

Brother Jon and I found each other through wrestling. His stepkids wrestled, I had wrestled, and that was the bridge.

You weren't wrestling when you were 5, were you? When did you start? This seems like a leap. You might tell us how old Lou's kids were when he entered your life. That's what's missing. If they were already adults, there was no sibling rivalry.

How old were Lou's kids when he came into your life?

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

—

him

Him who?

"Him who?" — antecedent unclear.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 4

Years later, I went out for the football team. Trying out meant a physical, and the physical meant turning in a copy of my birth certificate. I hadn't looked at mine in years. When I did, there was the word, printed plain for anyo...

I want to see this. Create a scene. Maybe with someone snatching it from your hands, reading it aloud, and what that person said or others said that made you feel diminished. Let the reader SEE what you felt and why it hurt so much.

Make the notebook moment a scene. Who took it, what was said.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

— already cut

when I was undone in front of him

We need some context for this conversation. Why were you undone? What did he see that inspired his words? How did his words comfort you?

Why you were undone, and what he saw.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 6

and the cafeteria I could not win.

I don't know what this means.

He can't parse the meaning.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 6

no one to catch her.

Come up with something more salient to her bringing you out of Mexico.

Something more specific about her bringing you out of Mexico.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 7

Then: "That's who you are."

Referring to what? Is he talking about the advancing bracket? If so, you're saying that winning was the identity that Lou put on you. Clarify.

Clarify what "it" refers to — the bracket, or the identity Lou put on you.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 7

He was the first person I loved who was just gone.

Again, I'm conflicted by what you've said about Horatio earlier and his exclusion in your drinking reference a bit ago and here. You'd lost him, too. Why did it feel different? Because he was still alive somewhere?

Why losing Papa felt different from the other loss.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

— already cut

Then there's the story I heard after my dad passes away. When my dad was a teenager, a man my dad knew, someone who carried real weight in certain circles, pulled up outside his house.

I found your original writing confusing. Was this guy your dad or a guy your dad knew. I rewrote it as if it were your dad. If it's not, reject my changes and rewrite to make it clear.

Was this your dad or a man your dad knew? He rewrote it as your dad — reject if wrong.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

—

The man

Is Lou the man, or is the man the one he rented the goat from? Ambiguously written.

Is Lou the man, or the man he rented the goat from?

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 11

I think about those four years and I thank God for my dad. Lou could have sent me to community college, a local school, a hundred cheaper options. Instead he let me go to Miami and took out loans to do it.

This brings up confusing thoughts, motives, and actions. You're grateful that your dad worked two jobs and took out loans so you could go to a school and party your ass off? This comes off as tone deaf and/or selfish. Think through what it is you want this to convey, because I don't think this is what you mean. I think your confusing the fun you had when your addiction was still working for you and general gratitude for your dad. But I don't know from what you've written. I don't know your intent, but given what you've shared, here's what I would have felt: delight that I could finally "become" the person I'd always wanted to be while feeling guilty that my dad sacrificed so much to give me this experience that I knew was slowly killing me.

Only you know the intent. He reads it as tone-deaf gratitude.

☐ NEEDS YOUR MEMORY

Ch 11

If he was in pain he wouldn't use the word.

What does this mean?

He can't parse the meaning.

Your call

Judgment or structure. Six of these change the shape of the book. **22**

☐ YOUR CALL

Ch 1

Everybody around me knew something I didn't.

This is where I think your chapter ends. As you leave the airport, New Jersey is your new life. This last line should stand on its own. It has two meanings. In addition, we chase being and feeling "just like everyone else." In recovery, we realize that (1) we are not like everyone else in the sense that we can't drink like "normal people," and (2) in recovery we learn that the people in those rooms know something we don't know.

Where Ch1 ends. He wants the last line standing alone.

☐ YOUR CALL

—

Badder-Ass.

Interjecting a little kid humor since I know pain is coming. The key for a story like yours is to be self-deprecating and self-aware, even when you may have lacked self-awareness of everything at once. The wounds from adoption and being the "different" kid are deep and hurtful.

His joke, inserted. Keep or reject.

☐ YOUR CALL

Ch 2

Then there was my nana, Jan, who could catch you off guard with her gentleness. One afternoon, not long after I'd learned about cowboys and Indians in school, she mentioned she had some American Indian in her. I burst into tears a...

I tried to tie the Cowboys/Indian story into the nails story. I loved the nail story and your feelings about losing your country, dad, etc. Powerfully written. I think this kind of experience is a shared one for alcoholics. We panic when we lose control.

He tied the Cowboys/Indians story to the nails story.

☐ YOUR CALL

—

I don't think this story reflects gentleness. What was her intention in telling you? Did she believe you'd find it an interesting fact? And for the love of everything that is holy, must we as American citizens always find a race of people to exterminate, feel superior to, and oppress? Today it's people with dark skin; yesterday, it was Native Americans.

His note on the Native American passage. Judgment call on whether to name it.

☐ YOUR CALL

Ch 3

"No excuses," he confided in me years later. "I wasn't the best dad. My kids deserved a better one than the one they got."

Changed to make this come from him, and I said it more like he would have told you.

He rewrote this to come from Lou in Lou's voice.

☐ YOUR CALL

Ch 3

I've never once wished it back.

Consider cutting this line. You've said nothing about your Papa that makes him a bad person or father. He gave you life and, like many of us, he struggled with addiction. He didn't leave you; your mom left him. He didn't leave you and Chris; alcohol took him. Up to this point, the reader has no reason to feel any ill-will to either your old or new "dad."

Cut the line about Papa — he argues nothing so far makes Papa a bad father.

☐ YOUR CALL

Ch 5

When my turn came, it was the wrestling tournaments upstate. Dad drove me up into New York weekend after weekend, however far the bracket took us. He didn't talk about the miles, the early start, or that he had worked the night be...

You've combined wrestling trips with watching sporting events. To make this work, the subject for these paragraphs is that your dad loved driving when it showed you how much he loved you.

Wrestling trips and spectator trips are merged. He suggests one subject: driving as proof of love.

☐ YOUR CALL

— already cut

THE DRIVES · IHe woke me early on a Saturday with the keys already in his hand. You want to take a ride? Ten hours of road, there and back, so a twelve-year-old could stand in a dim room and look at a ball Babe Ruth touched. He ne...

I don't know what this is hanging at the end of Part I and the start of Part II.

The interstitial between Parts — he doesn't know what it is.

☐ YOUR CALL

Part Two

THE MATLove came free at home. Everywhere else, I thought you had to win it.

I don't know what this is or why it's here.

Same: doesn't know what this is or why it's here.

☐ YOUR CALL

Ch 6

she didn't dress it up: there will never be another man like Charlie. She hasn't dated in years.

This indicated he's no longer in the picture. I'm assuming you'll come back around to this, but just leaving this note here to see if your explanation for his disappearance hits at the right time and with the right impact.

Flag only — he's watching whether Papa's disappearance pays off later.

Years later, I returned to that same tournament and left as Bergen County champion.

Make sure this is the best place to land this line. You COULD hold it back, build up to it, and then bring it out as you look back to your first time at that event, like, “I never imagined I’d attend ___ years later and leave as champion.”

Consider holding this line back and paying it off at the championship.

CooperstownCooperstown, New York, 1991

Consider moving this back chronologically. You’ve just finished summarizing your high school wrestling career. That seems like a perfect pivot point for what comes next: college and beyond. Perhaps these other stories that go back to your earlier years should fall earlier in the story so it doesn’t pull the reader away from the powerful section on wrestling and the foreshadowing you’ve built.

MAJOR. Move the earlier-years material earlier so the wrestling summary pivots straight into college.

Dave MeyerThe projections had Dave Meyer at quarterback, until a kid named Michael Vick showed up.But Dave’s story began for me at church, the other place, besides wrestling, where Lou made sure Chris and I showed up. Lou believed...

Great section, but it too seems out of place. And the Michael Vick reference falls like name-dropping instead of adding value. Two non-parallel stories: Dave and Citroen. Perhaps the drinking story belongs in your earlier wrestling section after making weight. A segue like, “As messed up as it was to starve myself and then binge on everything in sight, I picked up some other behaviors that did much more harm than good. (enter the drinking story).” But Dave, I don’t know where he fits. He could be part of your regular routine: “school and practice M-F; church on Sunday with Lou and Chris. Which is where I met Dave...”

MAJOR. Dave and the Citroen are two non-parallel stories in the wrong place. Vick reads as name-dropping.

The MarksThe discipline and habits I picked up in my wrestling years left marks I still feel. For a long time, my body didn’t feel like my own. It was something to manage, a number to beat, proof I deserved my place. Food stayed c...

I’ve just figured out something that’s been bothering me. Subheadings. It’s unusual for a memoir to include them. In some cases, you use them to tell us what you’re about to tell us. In other words, they’re redundant. In other cases, I think it makes your flow less tight. While I like everything you put in this short sub, I’d prefer tighter writing, which in this case means putting these details and your awareness where they add to other parts of the story instead of standalones, especially when they end a chapter. Let me add this. I realize I haven’t been a gushing, encouraging writing coach in my edits. I’m sorry for that. I have deadlines, clients, and personal issues drawing and quartering me. But let me say it here as a universal about your writing and your story: IT’S VERY WELL DONE. YOU DID A GREAT JOB WITH THIS! The things I’m changing and suggesting are high-level tweaks, many of which come down to how a word or phrase hits me as a reader, and they are not a matter of right or wrong. Since you’re writing/ story is so strong, I’m pushing you to take it to the highest level.

MAJOR. Cut subheadings book-wide. Also contains his apology and his strongest praise.

☐ YOUR CALL

— already cut

No one could keep a man like Lou down.

Do you see the different between active (what I rewrote) and passive voice (your original)? Active reads cleaner.

Active vs passive. He rewrote it and is showing you the difference.

☐ YOUR CALL

—

What do you think about shortening the title?

Shorten the chapter title.

☐ YOUR CALL

STRUCTURAL

Ch 9

New York, 1997

This is a big jump. The last chapter was 1993. I suggest you rework the previous content chronologically as best as you can, ending with your high school wrestling record and observation about being a winner (identity). It was powerful. Then pick up here, post high school (unless you're going to go back in time later. In that case, pick it up chronologically).

MAJOR. Big time jump. Rework the preceding material chronologically, end on the wrestling record, then pick up after high school.

☐ YOUR CALL

— already cut

One of those guys with a nickname like Mickey Marbles or Paulie the Piece. His office wasn't an office; it was a back room with one other person in it, an Italian girl named Felicia. That was the whole operation. "You're gonna be ...

Trying to add some humor since much of your story is so heavy and poignant.

His added humor. Keep or reject.

☐ YOUR CALL

STRUCTURAL

Ch 10

he career, MTV, the Abercrombie shoots,

This flags to me that you're going out of chrono order. Which makes me concerned that you've done a masterful job of showing what it feels like to hit bottom, but you're nowhere near bottom yet. If that's the case, consider adjusting and moving things. Normalize the drinking and drugging longer so it's still working for you while you rise in life. Save this poignant cliff until it's no longer working for you, when you're no longer able to have your best life alongside your drug use.

MAJOR. You're showing bottom before you've reached bottom. Normalize the drinking longer.

☐ YOUR CALL

STRUCTURAL

Ch 10

I understand addiction now in a way I can finally explain. It doesn't mean you're using all the time. It means you want to use all the time. You can't wait for the next pill, the next drink, and some part of you is already countin...

This is what I mean. All true and powerful. But not in the right order. You can't have this awareness that getting sober is grief while you're still using. And until we get to that point in your story, save this. You've left plenty of hints for the reader that the wheels are going to come off. Now let your addiction grow slowly. Mine lasted for years before I tipped over into a world where it stopped working for me. Write it in such a way that the reader gets their hopes up that you'll course correct before failing miserably, even though they know your fall is coming. Giving them a dose of hope now releases the tension you need to create in them.

MAJOR. You can't know sobriety is grief while still using. Save it. Give the reader false hope first.

☐ YOUR CALL

— already cut

Senior year I lived with Dave Nesser, Dean Ferrera, and Jason Huet in a condo downtown. We were absolute pigs, and we destroyed that place. We were about to scatter.

This entire paragraph seems thrown in here. It hangs on nothing. You're on MTV, your brother's friend recognizes you, "I live in a condo my senior year" (never mind that a paragraph earlier and later you're a junior), and now back to chasing the feeling.

The paragraph hangs on nothing — MTV, recognition, the condo, back to chasing the feeling.

☐ YOUR CALL

STRUCTURAL

Ch 11

He worked two jobs in those years, and one of them was at a garden center, planting trees, a man in his fifties down on his knees in the dirt. And I was selfish with it. I'd call him for more money, not for books or rent but for d...

This is what I would have felt. Now, the challenge for you is to tell your story AS YOU LIVED IT—SELFISHLY, CARELESSLY, COLDLY. Don't go back and forth on what you felt when. Stay in your college years of depraved indifference about Lou. Let your feelings of guilt and remorse surface in recovery.

MAJOR. Tell it as you lived it — selfishly, carelessly. Let remorse surface in recovery, not during.

He liked it

Twenty-five of ninety notes are him telling you it works. Read these on a bad day. **25**

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 26

Jenny McCarthy poster and hung it on my wall, because making a place mine meant making it feel like me, right down to the parts a mother would rather not picture.

Great line and clarification.

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 2

Grief has a shape when somebody dies, something to point at, a day people mark on a calendar. What I had instead was a door I kept checking, quietly, for years, without ever admitting that's what I was doing.

Boom! Great line

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 2

My grandfather taught high school history. At home he was a simple man, and I loved him for it. He was devoted to Wendy's, the Frosties most of all, and told me once, dead serious, that the one hole in his life was that Wendy's wo...

Great show! I feel like I know him and like him, too.

☐ HE LIKED IT

—

Hahahaha! Awesome!

☐ HE LIKED IT

— already cut

Dementia took her in pieces, the person still in the room while the line kept dropping.

So true, powerful, and devastating.

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 2

To him, we didn't need a holiday to become superheroes. Looking back, I think he was trying to give us something no job, no country, and no amount of uncertainty could take away: the freedom to be kids.

Wow. Very wise and intuitive.

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 3

Lou was no saint, and I won't pretend he was. He had a temper that showed up at the wrong moments, and he knew that about himself. Most of it wasn't even anger; it was how he processed things he didn't like, out loud and with heat...

I can see this. Great writing and depth of understanding him.

☐ HE LIKED IT

—

basements

Those who know, know.

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 3

It was older than any of us,

YES! I saw this kind of explosive rage in my dad. Even when a situation put him at a 2 out of 10 on the anger scale, the things he carried from his youth kept him near a 10 most of the time. We never knew what would push him over.

☐ HE LIKED IT

—

Woodridge

Small world. I lived in Woodridge, IL until I was 24. My dad died in that house. My mom had dementia, and we eventually sold the house. They'd lived there together for 55 years. It was the only "home" I ever knew. 7304 Hawthorne Ave., Woodridge, IL, the only address I'll remember until I die.

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 3

“Change your first name to Robert,” he said. “Rob. And I’ll give you a hundred dollars.” I was eight. A hundred dollars was a fortune. I didn’t even have to think about it.

Hahaha! Love it! I did the same with my son when I wanted him to change to a school he didn’t want to attend.

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 3

But I had Lou, who understood that a boy who comes home quiet in the wrong way doesn’t need to be interrogated, he needs someone there.

Powerful line. Unusually written, which at first I didn’t care for, but then it clicked for me. Making it read more smoothly would destroy its poetry.

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 3

He stayed anyway, a plain fact he never bothered to announce: we were his, and that didn’t come undone because the marriage had.

Beautiful.

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 4

He didn’t make a thing of it. He finished tucking me in the way he had every other night, except now I had a word for him I hadn’t had a minute before.

Boom. Love this!

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 4

I’d take my eraser and rub the name out until the paper went soft and gray, and print the new one in the bald spot I’d left. Robert. Then I’d hand it back, and she’d smile like we’d fixed something together. It didn’t feel fixed. ...

Great imagery

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 6

That’s the part I sit with now.

Great follow up line

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 6

He showed his love in carpools, tournament weekends, church on Sundays, and thousands of hours sitting beside wrestling mats.

Love this line. That was my dad, too. No “I love yous”, no affection. Just showing up.

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 6

It also showed me a line I would cross years later with worse things than food.

Great link and foreshadowing

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 6

thirty-one and zero

Shit! Amazing!

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 7

cut nineteen pounds

What!? That's nuts!

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 7

who think grief needs proximity

Incredible insight

☐ HE LIKED IT

— already cut

Dad knew everybody, and in a deeper way than people who meet at

My soon-to-be son-in-law told my wife that's what he admires most about me. He said something like, "Even though Scott says he hates people, he can talk with anyone, complete strangers, and walk away lifelong friends." I never really thought about it, but I think that's an accurate description. I don't let people remain outsiders. If God brings you to me, you're family or will be.

☐ HE LIKED IT

— already cut

Adderall washed down with alcohol. Something in me went quiet, still. I'd turned off a pain that lived deep inside of me that had been with me for as long as I could remember. I was no longer the dark-skinned kid who didn't match ...

This! This took me back to romanticizing my addiction. When I was cool, charming, impervious to criticism, either that which came from within me or from those around me. You really captured it.

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 10

I was a stick of dynamite waiting to explode.

I could never tell when I was about to tip over the line and become a violent animal. But one sign was waking up in jail.

☐ HE LIKED IT

Ch 10

Not the high. The relief. I wasn't trying to escape myself. I was trying to get back to the only version of myself I was ever comfortable inside.

Man, I gotta get to a meeting. This hit me so hard that I could almost taste the scotch on my lips, that fleeting sensation of feeling "normal."

Already handled

Flagged against the old file; the current text is already right. **1**

☐ ALREADY HANDLED

siblings

Lisa's not a brother

Already correct: "a big sister and two big brothers."

Anchors matched by exact text against the current manuscript. Where a note reads "already cut," his copy predates a change and that line no longer exists.